

[NT Lesson 14](#): “Who Is My Neighbour?” (See NTL14 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us humble ourselves, forgive others, and show charity for one another. †1. Pres. Hunter

1. Jesus teaches that we must become as little children.

• Read [Matthew 18:1-6, 10-11, 14](#). “Except ye ... become as little children, ye shall not enter into ... heaven.”

• Matt. 18:1; [Mark 9:33-34](#). They “had disputed among themselves, who should be the greatest.”

†2. Ted Gibbons quotes Paul Toscana †3. Ted L. Gibbons

Why do you think the disciples were concerned about who would be the greatest in the Lord’s kingdom?

How might we sometimes make similar errors?

• Matt. 18:2-4; [Mark 9:35](#). “If any man desire to be first, the same shall be last of all, and servant of all.”

Why is it difficult to follow our Savior’s counsel?

How does His counsel compare with what the world teaches about how to achieve greatness?

What does it mean to become as little children? (See [Mosiah 3:19](#))

“Although children are not perfect, they have many qualities that we must develop to inherit the kingdom of heaven. These qualities include humility, meekness, and a willingness to believe.” (*Lesson Manual*)

What have you learned from children?

How can we become more childlike and more submissive to the will of our Father in Heaven?

• Matt. 18:6. “But who shall offend one of these little ones, it were better for him ... that he were drowned”.

See “footnote 6a; in this context, *offend* means to cause to stumble.” (*Lesson Manual*) †4. Elder M. Russell Ballard

How can being childlike ourselves help us care for children?

What can we do to carry out God’s will that “[not] one of these little ones should perish”? (Matthew 18:14.)

2. Through the parable of the unmerciful servant, Jesus teaches about forgiveness.

• Read Matthew [18:15, 21-35](#). Peter asked, “Lord how oft shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him?”

• Matt. 18:22. “I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.”

Why is it sometimes difficult to forgive?

How have you been blessed as you have forgiven others or been forgiven by them?

• Matt. 18:23-35. “Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account.”

How are we like the king’s servant in our debt to the Lord? †5. Ted L. Gibbons

What must we do to be forgiven of our “debt?”

What can we learn from the king’s example in forgiving others?

What are some of the dangers of not forgiving others?

3. Through the parable of the good Samaritan, Jesus teaches about charity.

• Read [Luke 10:25-37](#). A “lawyer stood up, and tempted him, saying, Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?”

• Luke 10:29-37. “But he, willing to justify himself, said unto Jesus, And who is my neighbour?”

What are some things you’ve learned from the parable of the good Samaritan?

• Luke 10:31-32. A “priest ... passed by on the other side. And ... a Levite ... passed by on the other side.”

What are some ways that people need help today?

What are some reasons we do not help others in need? (See [Mosiah 4:16-19](#).)

• Luke 10:33-35. The Samaritan “had compassion on him, And went to him, and bound up his wounds, ...”

What characteristics of a good neighbor did the Samaritan have?

How have you been blessed by “good Samaritans”?

How can we be or become “good Samaritans”? (See [Mosiah 4:26](#).)

Next Week: L15 “I Am the Light of the World”; See L15: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **President Howard W. Hunter:** “We need to remember that though we make our friends, God has made our neighbors—everywhere. Love should have no boundary; we should have no narrow loyalties.” (“[The Lord’s Touchstone](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986, 35)

†2. **Ted Gibbons quotes Paul Toscana:** Paul “had served admirably in other mission assignments... He was certain that he was soon to be a Zone Leader. But he was not chosen, and he was devastated. He wrote:

“ ‘It was at that moment when everything seemed blackest, when I could no longer endure the taste of my own bitter self, that I suddenly filled with an illuminating insight that burst like a light in a dark place.

“ ‘It was as if a voice had spoken to me – not the voice of my own mind, but some other, greater mind. It was as if someone said to me, “What you really want is a sign that you are acceptable to Jesus Christ. A Church calling is not that sign; the true sign is the Holy Ghost...

“ ‘I began to understand the truth: what I wanted more than anything was to know that I was worthwhile, that I had somehow pleased my Savior, that I had somehow gained his love and trust. I had looked forward to a Church calling as a sign that I was worthwhile, a sign that I was acceptable to my mission president, to the Church, and most of all, to the Lord. But I had forgotten that a leadership position is not the sign the Lord gives to those whom he accepts; the true sign of his approbation is the Holy Ghost – the power, the fruits, and the gifts of the Spirit.’ ” (Paul James Toscana, “Confession of a Would-be Zone Leader,” *The New Era*, Jan-Feb, 1981, p. 37. Cited by Ted L. Gibbons, “[New Testament Lesson 14](#).”)

†3. **Ted L. Gibbons:** “I believe that this concern about rank and status still exists in the church. It is a subject rarely discussed, but certainly there are many who wonder why a call (or a greater call) has never come. *Will I be a den leader forever? Why can’t I work with the Laurels? Or, I’ve been on the High Council for years and the Stake Mission President for about as long. Now they want me to be the Scoutmaster in my ward? Or, Why did they call him to be a counselor to the Bishop. I know I am more qualified than he is.* (Ted L. Gibbons, “[New Testament Lesson 14](#).”)

†4. **Elder M. Russell Ballard:** “We hear disturbing reports of parents or guardians who are so far removed from the Spirit of Christ that they abuse children. Whether this abuse is physical, verbal, or the less evident but equally severe emotional abuse, it is an abomination and a serious offense to God.” (“[Teach the Children](#),” *Ensign*, May 1991, 80)

†5. **Ted L. Gibbons:** “The talent was a measure of weight. Its value was determined by the material of which it was composed. Likewise, the ‘hundred pence’ owed to the first servant by one of his fellows represents a money value based on weight. (See Matthew 18:28) ‘Pence’ was the word used in the King James Version to represent the Greek word ‘denarii.’ One talent was worth six thousand denarii.

“In Matthew 20:2 we read that the pence or denarius was a day’s wages for a common laborer. At that rate, the second servant would be able to pay off his debt in a little more than three months if he dedicated all of his income to the task. But the first servant, who owed the ten thousand talents, would have needed one hundred and fifty thousand years of toil to pay off his debt to the king.

“Because these measures of weight and coinage were probably silver (although gold is a possibility) we are able to compare their value, and the debt they represent, in contemporary dollars. Recently, silver was selling on the world market at about \$17.35 per ounce. At that price, one talent of 750 ounces would be worth \$13,012.50 [corrected]. But the debt of the unmerciful servant was not one talent; it was ten thousand talents, making the total debt around \$130,125,000.00 [corrected]! The denarius, at one eighth of an ounce, would be worth about \$2.18 and the total debt of the second servant would have been about \$218.00.

“Using the gold standard, the debt of the first servant would have been somewhere around \$9,472,500,000; the debt of the second about \$15,796.

“Surely the relative debts are a part of the lesson the Savior intended to teach. Talents and denarii were as familiar to his listeners as dollars and cents are to us. The significance of the difference between the two debts would not have been lost on those disciples, and it must not be lost on us. The declaration of the Lord in D&C 64:9 suddenly takes on a great deal more meaning.

“ ‘Wherefore, I say unto you, that ye ought to forgive one another; for he that forgiveth not his brother his trespasses standeth condemned before the Lord; for there remaineth in him the GREATER SIN.’ ” (Emphasis added) (Ted L. Gibbons, *Misery and Joy*, [Keepsake, 1991], pp. 76, 77. Cited in “[New Testament Lesson 14](#).”)

Recommended Reading:

1. President Howard W. Hunter, “[The Lord’s Touchstone](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986, 35.

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